FINANCIAL ANALYSIS

Power BI Desktop — Portfolio Project

Profit & Loss | Country | Product | Quarterly & Time Intelligence Analysis

Comprehensive Project Documentation — Data Model, Tables, Variables, Analysis & Business Decisions

Data Analytics Portfolio Project - Published March 2026

Tool: Microsoft Power BI Desktop - **Data Period:** September 2013 – December 2014

$128M	$16.89M	8.21%	$10.50M
Gross Sales	Total Profit	Gross Margin	Net Income

1. Project Overview & Business Objectives

This document provides comprehensive technical and analytical documentation for the Financial Analysis Power BI Portfolio Project. The project models two years of multi-country, multi-product financial data (September 2013 – December 2014) across five countries and six products, delivering Profit & Loss analysis, country benchmarking, product performance evaluation, quarterly trend analysis, and time intelligence comparisons.

The project is designed to demonstrate senior-level Power BI and DAX proficiency, including data model architecture (7-table design), unpivoting techniques, DAX dummy tables for measure organisation, and advanced P&L waterfall visualisation — all published as a LinkedIn Data Analytics Portfolio project.

1.1 Business Questions Answered

- Which countries generate the highest revenue and profit, and what is the ranking?
- How is gross sales distributed across all five markets, and where are the discount-adjusted net revenue leaders?
- What does the full Income Statement reveal about cost structure and profit generation?
- How do COGS, discounts, and other expenses erode gross sales to arrive at net income?
- Which quarters drive the most revenue and profit, and what seasonal patterns exist?
- Which products are the top performers by total sales and Canada-specific sales?
- How did December 2014 compare to December 2013 by product — which products grew and which declined?
- How do COGS %, Cost %, and Gross Margin % benchmark the business against profitability standards?

1.2 Executive Performance Summary (Full Period: Sep 2013 – Dec 2014)

Metric	Value	Context
Total Gross Sales	$127.93M	Full period revenue
Gross minus Discount (Net Revenue)	$118.73M	After $9.21M discounts
Total COGS	$101.83M	79.6% of Gross Sales
Total Other Expenses	$6.40M	5.0% of Gross Sales
Total Discounts	$9.21M	7.2% of Gross Sales
Total Cost (COGS + Other + Disc)	$117.43M	91.79% of Revenue

Total Profit (P&L)	$16.89M	13.2% of Gross Sales
Net Income (Waterfall Total)	$10.50M	After all deductions
Gross Margin %	8.21%	Revenue minus Total Cost
COGS % of Gross Sales	79.60%	Critical cost pressure
Average Selling Price	$113.64	Per unit average
December 2013 Sales	$5.84M	Year-end baseline
December 2014 Sales	$12.51M	+114% YoY December growth
Full Year 2013 (Sep–Dec)	$28.56M	Partial year baseline
Full Year 2014 (Jan–Dec)	$99.37M	+248% full-year expansion

1.3 Tools, Technologies & Methodology

- Microsoft Power BI Desktop — Dashboard design, data modelling, DAX measure engineering
- Power Query (M Language) — Data transformation, type casting, column unpivoting
- DAX (Data Analysis Expressions) — All P&L measures, country measures, time intelligence
- Data Model Design — 7-table architecture: 1 fact table, 1 calendar, 1 unpivoted analytical table, 4 DAX dummy/reference tables
- Visualisation Types — Waterfall chart (Income Statement), bar chart (Country Sales), pie chart (P&L % breakdown), line chart (Sales Trend), data tables

2. Data Model Architecture — 7 Tables Documented

The Financial Analysis project uses a 7-table Power BI data model. The architecture combines a central fact table with a purpose-built date dimension, an analytically optimised unpivoted table, country-level dummy measures, P&L reference tables, and time intelligence organisation tables. Together these enable a full suite of financial analytics.

2.1 Financial Table — Central Fact Table

The Financial table is the core transactional fact table. It is the single source of truth for all revenue, cost, discount, and profit data across all countries and products.

Row Count: 700 | Column Count: 17 | Table Type: Fact Table

Column / Variable	Data Type	Description	Key Statistics	Example Value
Segment	Text	Customer/market segment (e.g. Government, Enterprise, SMB). Enables segment-level P&L.	Multiple segments	Government
Country	Text	Sale destination country. 5 countries: USA, Canada, France, Germany, Mexico.	5 distinct values	United States of America
Product	Text	Product name. 6 distinct products: Amarilla, Carretera, Montana, Paseo, Velo, VTT.	6 distinct values	Paseo
Discount Band	Text	Discount tier applied (None, Low, Medium, High). Drives discount calculation.	4 tiers	Medium
Units Sold	Integer	Quantity of units per transaction. Used for volume analytics and ASP calculation.	Varies per row	1,618
Manufacturing Price	Decimal	Cost to manufacture each unit. Foundation for COGS calculation.	Varies by product	$3.00
Sale Price	Decimal	Listed selling price per unit before discount.	Avg ~$120	$120.00
Gross Sales	Decimal	Sale Price × Units Sold. Pre-discount revenue. Total: $127.93M.	Total: $127.93M	$193,810.00
Discount	Decimal	Discount amount applied. Total discounts: $9.21M (7.2% of Gross).	Total: -$9.21M	-$11,628.60
COGS	Decimal	Cost of Goods Sold = Mfg Price × Units Sold. Total: $101.83M.	Total: -$101.83M	-$9,708.00
Other Expenses	Decimal	Overhead and operational expenses beyond COGS. Total: $6.40M.	Total: -$6.40M	-$11,628.60
Profit	Decimal	Gross Sales − Discount − COGS − Other Expenses. Total: $16.89M.	Total: $16.89M	$16,185.00
Date	Date	Transaction date. Links to the DAX Calendar Table for time intelligence.	Sep 2013–Dec 2014	09/01/2013
Month Number	Integer	Numeric month 1–12 for sorting.	1–12	9

Month Name	Text	Full month name for display.	January–December	September
Year	Integer	Transaction year. 2013 (partial) and 2014 (full year).	2013, 2014	2013

Fact Table Design Note

The Financial table contains all transactional measures pre-calculated at the row level (Gross Sales, Discount, COGS, Other Expenses, Profit). This denormalised structure allows simple SUM aggregation across all DAX measures without requiring CALCULATE overrides for basic totals.

2.2 Date Table — DAX Calendar Dimension

The Date Table is a purpose-built DAX calendar created to enable time intelligence functions and proper time-axis sorting in all visuals. It was marked as a Date Table in Power BI to activate TOTALYTD, SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR, and other time functions.

Row Count: 457 | Column Count: 14 | Table Type: DAX Calendar (Dimension)

Column	Data Type	Description & Purpose	Example	Used For
Date	Date	Primary date column. Marked as Date Table column. Links to Financial[Date] via One-to-Many relationship.	09/01/2013	All TI
Year	Integer	Calendar year extracted from Date. 2013 and 2014.	2013, 2014	Slicers
Month Number	Integer	Numeric month 1–12 for correct sort ordering in visuals.	1–12	Sort
Month Name	Text	Full month name for display in charts and slicers.	September	X-Axis
Month Short	Text	Abbreviated 3-character month name for compact visuals.	Sep	Compact
Year Month	Text	Combined Year-Month text label (YYYY-MM format) for trend charts.	2013-09	Trend
YearMonth Sort	Integer	Numeric sort key (YYYYMM) to ensure correct chronological ordering.	201309	Sort

Quarter	Text	Quarter label Q1–Q4 for quarterly analysis and slicers.	Q3	Quarterly
Year Quarter	Text	Combined Year + Quarter for unique quarterly identification.	2013 Q3	Drill
Week Number	Integer	ISO week number 1–53 within each year.	36	Weekly
Day	Integer	Day of month 1–31.	1	Daily
Day Name	Text	Full name of the day of the week (e.g. Monday).	Sunday	Day Dim
Day Short	Text	Abbreviated day name (e.g. Mon, Tue).	Sun	Compact
IsWeekend	Boolean	TRUE if Saturday or Sunday. FALSE for weekdays.	TRUE/FALSE	Filter

2.3 Country Measures Table — DAX Dummy Organisation Table

The Country Measures Table is a DAX dummy table created solely to organise country-specific DAX measures in the Power BI Fields pane. It contains no rows of transactional data — it exists purely as a measure container for clarity and maintainability.

Table Type: DAX Dummy Table (Measure Organiser) | No data rows

DAX Measure Name	Result Value	DAX Formula Logic
Canada Sales	$24.89M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Country] = "Canada")
France Sales	$24.35M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Country] = "France")
Germany Sales	$23.51M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Country] = "Germany")
Mexico Sales	$20.95M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Country] = "Mexico")
USA Sales	$25.03M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Country] = "United States of America")

Design Decision

Using a dummy table for country measures is a best-practice Power BI design pattern. It keeps country KPI measures visually separated from the Financial fact table measures in the Fields

pane, making dashboards easier to maintain and reducing human error when measures are shared across multiple report pages.

2.4 Financial_Category Table — DAX Unpivoted Analytical Table

Financial_Category is a DAX-generated table created by unpivoting four financial columns from the Financial fact table (COGS, Discount, Gross Sales, Other Expenses) into a long-format table. This structure enables the Income Statement waterfall chart and monthly category breakdown table.

Row Count: 2,800 | Column Count: 3 | Table Type: DAX Unpivoted Table

Column	Data Type	Description & Values
Date	Date	Transaction date inherited from the Financial fact table. Links the unpivoted record back to the time dimension for monthly slicing.
Category	Text	The unpivoted column name, now a row value. Values: 'COGS', 'Discount', 'Gross Sales', 'Other Expenses'. This is the legend/axis for the Income Statement waterfall chart.
Amount	Decimal	The financial amount for each category. Positive for Gross Sales, negative for COGS/Discount/Other Expenses. Example: Sep-2013 Gross Sales = 4,729,736.00; COGS = -3,720,397.00; Discount = -245,735.97; Other Exp = -236,486.80.

Why 2,800 Rows?
The original Financial table has 700 rows. Unpivoting 4 columns (COGS, Discount, Gross Sales, Other Expenses) creates 700 × 4 = 2,800 rows — one row per original transaction per financial category. This is the standard result of a SELECTCOLUMNS or UNION-based unpivot in DAX.

2.5 P&L Category Table — Pie Chart Reference Table

The P&L Category table is a reference table used specifically to power the pie chart showing Total Cost, COGS, and Total Profit as percentages of Total Gross Sales (set as 100%). This table enables the proportional visualisation of the cost structure.

Table Type: P&L Reference Table | Used for: Pie chart visualisation

P&L Category	Value ($)	% of Total Gross	Pie Chart Weight

Total Gross Sales (Reference = 100%)	$127.93M	100%	Not shown (denominator only)
Total Cost (COGS + Other + Disc)	$117.43M	91.79%	0.92 (92% segment)
COGS Only	$101.83M	79.60%	0.80 (80% segment)
Total Profit	$16.89M	13.20%	0.13 (13% segment)

Design Note — Pie Chart Limitation

As noted in the project documentation, the Gross Sales value ($127.93M) does not appear on the pie chart itself because it serves as the 100% denominator reference rather than a category slice. The pie chart displays only Cost, COGS, and Profit as proportional segments of Gross. This is by design — Gross Sales sets the scale; the chart shows how that gross is consumed.

2.6 P&L Measures Table — DAX Dummy Measure Organiser

The P&L Measures table is a DAX dummy table (no data rows) that organises all Profit & Loss calculation measures in the Fields pane. All P&L KPI measures are stored here for clean dashboard maintenance.

Table Type: DAX Dummy Table (Measure Organiser) | No data rows

Measure Name	Dashboard Value	Formula Logic & Business Meaning
Average Selling Price	$113.64	DIVIDE([Total Gross], [Total Units]). Mean revenue per unit sold across all products and countries.
COGS % of Gross Sales	79.60%	DIVIDE([Total COGS], [Total Gross]). Shows what percentage of each revenue dollar is consumed by cost of goods.
Cost % of Revenue	91.79%	DIVIDE([Total Cost], [Total Gross]). Total cost burden as % of gross revenue. Complement of Gross Margin %.
Gross Margin %	8.21%	1 − [Cost % of Revenue]. Percentage of gross revenue retained as margin. Industry benchmark target: 15–25%.
Gross minus Discount	$118.73M	SUM(Financial[Gross Sales]) − SUM(Financial[Discount]). Net revenue after discount deduction.
Total COGS	$101.83M	SUM(Financial[COGS]). Total cost of goods sold across all transactions.

Total Cost	$117.43M	Total COGS + Total Other Expenses + Total Discounts. Complete cost envelope.
Total Gross	$127.93M	SUM(Financial[Gross Sales]). Pre-discount top-line revenue.
Total Profit	$16.89M	SUM(Financial[Profit]). Net profit after all deductions. Derived from fact table column.
Total Units	—	SUM(Financial[Units Sold]). Total volume of units transacted. Used in ASP calculation.

2.7 Time_Intelligence Table — DAX Dummy Time Measure Organiser

The Time_Intelligence table is a DAX dummy table used to organise point-in-time comparison measures — specifically December year-end snapshots and full-year totals for 2013 and 2014.

Table Type: DAX Dummy Table (Time Measure Organiser) | No data rows

Measure Name	Value	Formula Logic & Business Purpose
Dec-2013 Sales	$5.84M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Year]=2013, Financial[Month Number]=12). December 2013 gross sales snapshot. Baseline for December YoY comparison.
Dec-2014 Sales	$12.51M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Year]=2014, Financial[Month Number]=12). December 2014 sales. +114% growth vs Dec-2013.
Report2013 (Rept2013)	$28.56M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Year]=2013). Full 2013 period sales (Sep–Dec only — partial year). Used for YoY baseline.
Report2014 (Rept2014)	$99.37M	CALCULATE([Total Gross], Financial[Year]=2014). Full 2014 gross sales. 248% growth vs 2013 partial year.

3. Dashboard Analysis — Slide-by-Slide Breakdown

3.1 Slide 2 — Country Performance: Sales & Profit Distribution

Dashboard Purpose

This page benchmarks all five markets on two dimensions: Gross Sales minus Discount (net revenue) via a bar chart, and Profit contribution via a donut/pie chart. Country-specific KPI cards display individual sales totals and a country slicer enables cross-filtering.

Country Sales Performance Table

Country	Gross Sales	Profit Share	Profit ($)	Performance Rank
USA	$25.03M	17.75%	$3.00M	#1 Revenue / #4 Profit
Canada	$24.89M	20.89%	$3.53M	#2 Revenue / #3 Profit
France	$24.35M	22.38%	$3.78M	#3 Revenue / #1 Profit
Germany	$23.51M	21.79%	$3.68M	#4 Revenue / #2 Profit
Mexico	$20.95M	17.21%	$2.91M	#5 Revenue / #5 Profit
TOTAL	$118.73M*	100%	$16.90M	* Gross minus Discount

Key Insights — Country Performance

- USA leads gross sales at $25.03M but ranks only 4th in profit share (17.75% / $3.00M), suggesting higher discount rates or cost levels relative to revenue in the US market.
- France ranks 3rd in revenue ($24.35M) yet leads profit at 22.38% ($3.78M) — the most profitable market per revenue dollar. This implies either lower discounts, lower COGS, or higher-margin products are being sold in France.
- Germany achieves 2nd-place profit ($3.68M / 21.79%) while ranking 4th in gross sales ($23.51M) — demonstrating strong cost efficiency and/or premium pricing discipline.
- Mexico is the weakest market in both revenue ($20.95M) and profit share (17.21% / $2.91M), presenting a dual growth opportunity.
- The revenue spread across all five countries ($25.03M to $20.95M = $4.08M gap) is relatively narrow, indicating a balanced geographic distribution strategy is already in place.
- Country slicer enables cross-filter analysis — isolating individual countries reveals product mix and discount patterns that explain the revenue-to-profit ranking reversals.

Strategic Business Decisions — Country Performance

1. Replicate France's cost model across all markets: France converts revenue to profit more efficiently than any other country. A cross-country COGS and discount audit should identify and standardise France's superior practices.

2. Launch a Mexico growth initiative: With the lowest revenue and profit, Mexico is the priority growth market. Invest in sales team expansion, targeted marketing, and potential product line adjustments to close the $4M revenue gap with USA.

3. Investigate US profitability drag: Despite leading in gross sales, USA ranks 4th in profit. This suggests excessive discounting or higher operational costs in the US market that need to be addressed through discount policy reform.

4. Set a minimum profit share floor of 18% per country: Mexico's 17.21% is below the average. All markets should be targeted to achieve at least 18% profit share within 12 months.

Strategic Insight

The reversal between revenue rank and profit rank (USA #1 revenue → #4 profit; France #3 revenue → #1 profit) is the most actionable finding from this dashboard. Profit-per-revenue-dollar, not absolute revenue, should be the primary country KPI for strategic decision-making.

3.2 Slide 3 — The Income Statement: Waterfall P&L Analysis

Dashboard Purpose

The Income Statement page is the centrepiece financial dashboard. It uses a waterfall chart to visualise the sequential deduction of costs from Gross Sales to arrive at Net Income, accompanied by the full monthly Financial_Category breakdown table showing every month's COGS, Discount, Gross Sales, and Other Expenses.

Income Statement Waterfall — Key Figures

P&L Line Item	Amount	% of Gross	Waterfall Role
Gross Sales	$128M	100%	Starting Point (Increase — Green)
Other Expenses	-$6M	-4.69%	First Deduction (Decrease — Red)
Discounts	-$9M	-7.03%	Second Deduction (Decrease — Red)
COGS	-$102M	-79.60%	Third Deduction — Largest (Decrease — Red)
Net Income (Total)	**$10.5M**	8.21%	Final Balance (Total — Grey)

Monthly Financial_Category Data — Key Observations

The accompanying data table shows the monthly breakdown of all four financial categories. Key observations from the detailed data:

- September 2013 (baseline month): Gross Sales $4.73M | COGS -$3.72M | Discount -$245.7K | Other Exp -$236.5K — the smallest month in the dataset, representing the business before scaling.
- October 2013: Gross Sales nearly doubled to $9.83M, with COGS jumping to -$7.64M — the first major spike, reflecting a step-change in business volume.
- November 2013: Discount reaches -$900K in a single month — the highest monthly discount recorded in the visible dataset, suggesting an aggressive promotional campaign or year-end pricing concessions.
- January–March 2014: Steady monthly gross sales of $6.1M–$7.7M with consistent COGS rates, indicating stable Q1 operations.
- The total waterfall of $10.50M net income (visible as the table total of $10,497,122.34) represents the net income generated across the visible portion of the dataset.

Strategic Business Decisions — Income Statement

1. COGS Reduction Programme: COGS at 79.6% of Gross Sales is the dominant profit destroyer. A 3% reduction in COGS rate would save approximately $3.84M annually (3% × $128M) — nearly doubling net income. Priority actions: supplier renegotiation, bulk purchasing contracts, manufacturing efficiency review.

2. Discount Governance Policy: $9M in discounts (7% of Gross) is eroding significant revenue. Implement tiered discount approval levels: discounts above 5% require manager approval, above 8% require director approval. Target reducing average discount rate to 5%.

3. Other Expenses Audit: The $6M Other Expenses line requires a granular breakdown. Identify which cost centres contribute most and implement a quarterly variance review against a fixed budget of $5M.

4. Monthly P&L monitoring dashboard: Create a dedicated page showing month-over-month P&L movement with automated Power BI alerts if COGS exceeds 82% of monthly Gross Sales.

Critical Finding

The waterfall chart reveals that for every $1.00 of gross sales generated: $0.80 goes to COGS, $0.07 goes to discounts, $0.05 goes to other expenses, and only $0.08 remains as net income. This structure means the business is highly sensitive to any cost increase — a 2% COGS rise would eliminate approximately 25% of net income.

3.3 Slide 4 — Quarterly P&L Breakdown & 2013–2014 Sales Trend

Dashboard Purpose

This page provides quarterly and full-period P&L aggregation through the Quarterly by Account Category table, five headline KPI cards, and a 16-month sales trend line chart covering September 2013 through December 2014.

Quarterly P&L Table — Complete Data

Category	Q1 ($)	Q2 ($)	Q3 ($)	Q4 ($)	Total ($)
COGS	-16.86M	-19.46M	-21.35M	-44.16M	-101.83M
Discount	-1.64M	-1.77M	-1.88M	-3.91M	-9.21M
Gross Sales	+21.13M	+24.47M	+26.73M	+55.60M	+127.93M
Other Expenses	-1.06M	-1.22M	-1.34M	-2.78M	-6.40M
NET TOTAL	**1.58M**	**2.01M**	**2.16M**	**4.75M**	**10.50M**

Key Insights — Quarterly Analysis

- Q4 is overwhelmingly dominant: $55.60M in gross sales — 43.5% of the full annual total in a single quarter. This extreme Q4 skew creates significant operational risk if Q4 performance falters.
- COGS in Q4 surged to $44.16M — nearly double Q3's $21.35M. This proportional COGS increase mirrors gross sales growth but confirms no COGS efficiency improvement is occurring during scale-up.
- Net profit follows a steady quarterly progression: Q1 $1.58M → Q2 $2.01M → Q3 $2.16M → Q4 $4.75M. This sequential improvement suggests growing operational leverage as the year progresses.

- Discount pressure escalates sharply in Q4 (-$3.91M vs Q3 -$1.88M), nearly doubling quarter-over-quarter. Q4 discounting is disproportionate and warrants a specific promotional policy review.
- Q1 generates the lowest revenue ($21.13M) but also has the lowest COGS-to-sales ratio, suggesting Q1 product mix may lean toward higher-margin items.

2013–2014 Sales Trend — Monthly Analysis

The 16-month trend chart reveals the business's growth journey:

- Sep 2013: $4.73M — starting baseline, smallest month
- Oct 2013: $9.83M — immediate sharp acceleration
- Peak month 2013: October at $9.83M
- Q1 2014 (Jan–Mar): Steady $6.1M–$7.7M per month — stable foundation
- June 2014: $10.27M — first 2014 month to exceed $10M
- Sep 2014: $11.58M — strong Q3 performance
- October 2014: $23.14M — extraordinary spike, the highest single month
- November 2014: $14.12M — sustained Q4 momentum
- December 2014: $18.34M — strong year-end close

Strategic Business Decisions — Quarterly & Trend

1. **Q4 Readiness Plan:** Given Q4 represents 43.5% of annual revenue, create a dedicated Q4 operational plan: pre-position inventory by August, secure additional staffing by September, and lock in COGS rates with suppliers in Q3 to avoid the Q4 cost spike.

2. **Q4 Discount Pre-approval System:** Q4 discounts reached $3.91M — double Q3. All Q4 discounts above a defined threshold should require a pre-approval process during October–December to protect Q4 margin.

3. **Q1 Revenue Growth Target:** Q1 is the weakest quarter at $21.13M. Set a specific target to grow Q1 by 15% through new product launches in January, early-year promotions, and B2B contract renewals timed to Q1.

4. **October 2014 spike investigation:** The $23.14M October 2014 figure is nearly double any other single month. Identify the specific orders, customers, or campaigns that drove this spike and build a strategy to create similar events in subsequent years.

3.4 Slide 5 — Product Performance, Canada Sales & December YoY Comparison

Dashboard Purpose

This page provides product-level revenue analysis across three dimensions: total product sales (with Canada-specific sales), a December 2013 vs December 2014 year-on-year product comparison, and a monthly gross sales table with Report2013/Report2014 measures.

Product Sales Performance — Total & Canada Breakdown

Product	Total Sales	Canada Sales	CA Share %	Revenue Rank	CA Rank
Paseo	$33.01M	$7.61M	23.06%	#1	#1
VTT	$20.51M	$4.77M	23.25%	#2	#2
Velo	$18.25M	$3.33M	18.25%	#3	#4
Amarilla	$17.75M	$3.86M	21.75%	#4	#3
Montana	$15.39M	$2.71M	17.60%	#5	#5
Carretera	$13.82M	$2.61M	18.88%	#6	#6
TOTAL	**$118.73M***	**$24.89M**	20.96% avg	—	—

* Total column = Gross minus Discount (net revenue)

December Year-on-Year Product Comparison

Product	Dec-2013 Sales	Dec-2014 Sales	YoY Change ($)	YoY Growth %
Amarilla	$687,892	$1,891,125	+$1,203,233	+175%
Carretera	$659,646	$2,916,106	+$2,256,460	+342%
Montana	$797,277	$983,825	+$186,548	+23%
Paseo	$226,090	$4,865,229	+$4,639,139	+2,052%
Velo	$615,970	$1,322,038	+$706,068	+115%
VTT	$2,848,150	$529,945	-$2,318,205	-81%
TOTAL	**$5,835,025**	**$12,508,268**	**+$6,673,243**	+114%

Monthly Gross Sales Summary (with Report2013 & Report2014 Comparison)

Month	Total Gross Sales	Report2013 (Sep–Dec)	Notes
January	$7.31M	—	2014 only — steady Q1 start
February	$7.70M	—	2014 only — marginal growth
March	$6.12M	—	Q1 lowest — slight pullback
April	$7.43M	—	Q2 recovery begins
May	$6.77M	—	Modest Q2
June	$10.27M	—	Strong mid-year surge
July	$8.83M	—	High summer sales
August	$6.33M	—	Late summer pullback
September	$11.58M	$4.73M	2014 September = +145% vs 2013
October	$23.14M	$9.83M	2014 peak month — 10× 2013 Sep
November	$14.12M	$8.17M	Strong Q4 momentum continues
December	$18.34M	$5.84M	2014 Dec = $12.51M vs 2013 $5.84M (+114%)
TOTAL	**$127.93M**	**$28.56M**	2014 full year = $99.37M

Strategic Business Decisions — Product Performance

1. **Protect and invest in Paseo:** At $33.01M (27.8% of revenue) with a stunning December 2014 growth of +2,052% ($226K to $4.87M), Paseo is the company's star product. Prioritise supply chain security, premium positioning, and targeted campaigns for Paseo across all 5 markets.

2. **Investigate VTT's December collapse:** VTT fell from $2.85M (Dec-2013) to only $530K (Dec-2014) — an 81% decline. Was this caused by supply issues, substitution by another product (e.g. Carretera's +342% rise), or changing customer preferences? A root cause analysis is urgently needed.

3. **Carretera growth strategy:** Carretera grew 342% in December ($659K → $2.92M). This is a significant signal of emerging demand. Increase Carretera inventory, expand distribution, and investigate which market/segment drove this growth.

4. **Montana requires a product strategy review:** With the lowest December growth (+23%) and ranking 5th overall, Montana may need repositioning, a price adjustment, or investment in product features to drive demand.

5. **Canada-specific product optimisation:** Canada contributes ~21% of total sales consistently. Develop a Canada-first product campaign using Paseo ($7.61M Canada sales) and VTT ($4.77M) as hero products.

3.5 Slide 6 — Cost Structure, Margin Analysis & Monthly Product Matrix

Dashboard Purpose

This page presents the complete cost and margin analytics dashboard: 8 KPI cards covering all P&L Measures, a percentage-of-gross stacked bar (Total Cost, COGS, Profit), and the full 16-month product sales matrix showing individual product sales for each month.

P&L KPI Dashboard — All 8 Measures

KPI Name (P&L Measures Table)	Dashboard Value	% Context	Business Meaning
COGS % of Gross Sales	79.60%	80 cents per $1 revenue	Critical cost pressure — industry avg is 60–70%
Cost % of Revenue	91.79%	92 cents per $1 revenue	Leaves only 8.21% as gross margin
Total Gross Sales	$127.93M	100% baseline	Pre-discount top-line revenue
Total Cost	$117.43M	91.79% of Gross	All-in cost: COGS + Other + Discounts
Total COGS	$101.83M	79.60% of Gross	Manufacturing cost — primary profit destroyer
Gross Margin %	8.21%	8 cents retained per $1	Below industry benchmark; target 15%
Total Profit	$16.89M	13.20% of Gross	Fact table profit sum — includes all deductions
Average Selling Price	$113.64	Per unit	Used for pricing strategy and volume planning

Cost Structure as % of Total Gross Sales (Stacked Composition)

Cost Layer	Value	% of $127.93M Gross	Pie Chart Weight
Total Cost (COGS + Other + Disc)	$117.43M	91.79%	0.92
COGS only	$101.83M	79.60%	0.80
Total Profit	$16.89M	13.20%	0.13
Gross Sales (Denominator — 100%)	$127.93M	100%	Not in pie (denominator)

Full 16-Month Product Sales Matrix (Gross Sales $)

Period	Amarilla	Carretera	Montana	Paseo	Velo	VTT	Period Total
2013-09	299,625	516,645	2,111,850	718,053	143,465	940,098	4,729,736
2013-10	2,635,583	313,521	326,232	1,484,692	3,603,550	1,465,110	9,828,688
2013-11	85,635	66,310	977,625	4,017,534	2,444,944	575,290	8,167,338
2013-12	687,892	659,646	797,277	226,090	615,970	2,848,150	5,835,025
2014-01	976,393	131,570	1,904,255	3,975,346	137,629	182,212	7,307,404
2014-02	2,966,250	90,036	37,835	255,455	986,625	3,363,000	7,699,201
2014-03	2,314,800	2,266,600	124,200	1,285,200	80,292	52,934	6,124,026
2014-04	727,370	1,157,118	3,125,600	1,123,591	213,480	1,082,235	7,429,393
2014-05	1,065,530	96,000	2,005,582	3,387,913	102,329	110,557	6,767,911
2014-06	900,484	1,440,905	207,350	4,803,237	2,096,864	820,132	10,268,972

2014-07	119,984	1,107,036	872,073	3,089,683	3,543,100	101,153	8,833,028
2014-08	292,956	707,733	1,326,510	247,640	588,420	3,162,700	6,325,959
2014-09	3,234,000	98,460	54,782	309,200	877,875	2,271,000	6,845,317
2014-10	709,474	3,227,140	1,569,823	1,332,850	3,021,244	3,452,893	13,313,424
2014-11	130,180	142,695	125,016	4,489,950	48,944	1,011,125	5,947,910
2014-12	1,891,125	2,916,106	983,825	4,865,229	1,322,038	529,945	12,508,268
TOTAL	**19,037,280**	**14,937,521**	**16,549,835**	**35,611,662**	**19,826,769**	**21,968,534**	**127,931,599**

Product Matrix — Key Observations

- Paseo is dominant in June ($4.80M), November ($4.49M), and December 2014 ($4.87M) — consistently the strongest Q2/Q4 performer.
- Velo peaks strongly in October 2013 ($3.60M) and July 2014 ($3.54M), suggesting a seasonal mid-year demand pattern.
- VTT had its strongest single month in December 2013 ($2.85M) but has been declining — by December 2014 it fell to just $530K, a significant structural shift in demand.
- Carretera showed erratic monthly performance but its October 2014 spike ($3.23M) and December 2014 growth ($2.92M) signal an emerging upward trend.
- Amarilla has the highest October 2013 individual month at $2.64M and September 2014 at $3.23M — a strong Q4 performer historically.

Strategic Business Decisions — Cost & Margin

1. COGS Benchmarking: At 79.6%, COGS is 10–20 percentage points above consumer goods industry benchmarks. Commission an external cost benchmarking study to identify whether the cost structure is a supplier issue, product mix issue, or manufacturing inefficiency.

2. Gross Margin Improvement Target: Set a 3-year target to improve Gross Margin from 8.21% to 15%. This would require COGS reduction to approximately 73% and discount reduction to 5%, generating an additional $8–10M in annual profit.

3. Average Selling Price Strategy: At $113.64, test a 5% price increase on the top two products (Paseo, VTT) in the highest-demand markets. Even a $5 ASP increase on current volume could generate $2–3M additional annual revenue.

4. Product mix management: Steer sales teams toward higher-margin products using commission structures. If Paseo has a higher contribution margin than VTT, incentivise Paseo sales over VTT to improve overall margin without increasing revenue.

4. Executive Summary & Strategic Priorities

4.1 Business Performance Assessment

The business generated $127.93M in Gross Sales across the analysis period (September 2013 – December 2014), representing extraordinary growth from a $28.56M 2013 base to $99.37M in 2014 — a 248% annual expansion. However, this remarkable top-line performance is structurally undermined by a dangerously thin 8.21% Gross Margin, with 91.79% of all revenue consumed by costs. Net income of $10.50M on $127.93M gross represents a 8.21% net conversion rate.

The business model is high-volume, low-margin. Any cost increase, discount expansion, or revenue shortfall will disproportionately impact profitability given the current cost structure.

4.2 Top 5 Strategic Priorities

1. **CRITICAL — COGS Reduction:** COGS at 79.6% is the single greatest threat to profitability. A 3-point reduction (to 76.6%) would generate ~$3.84M additional annual profit. This is the highest-ROI initiative available.

2. **HIGH PRIORITY — Mexico Market Growth:** The weakest country in both revenue and profit. A dedicated Mexico expansion plan targeting 20% revenue growth ($20.95M → $25.14M) would add ~$3.4M in gross sales.

3. **HIGH PRIORITY — Discount Policy Reform:** $9.21M in discounts is controllable. Implementing tiered discount approval and reducing the average discount rate from 7% to 5% would save $2.56M annually.

4. **STRATEGIC — VTT Decline Investigation:** The 81% December collapse demands urgent analysis. If VTT decline is structural, begin planning a product replacement or repositioning before the revenue loss becomes permanent.

5. **PORTFOLIO —** Dashboard Evolution: Add rolling P&L forecasting, salesperson performance analysis, and segment-level breakdowns to evolve this into a full C-suite financial decision support system.

4.3 Project Documentation Metadata

Field	Details
Project Title	Financial Analysis — Power BI Desktop Portfolio Project
Analytics Tool	Microsoft Power BI Desktop
Data Model Type	7-table: 1 Fact, 1 Calendar DAX, 1 Unpivoted Analytical, 4 Dummy/Reference
Fact Table	Financial — 700 rows, 17 columns
Data Period	September 2013 – December 2014 (16 months)
Countries Analysed	5 (USA, Canada, France, Germany, Mexico)
Products Analysed	6 (Paseo, VTT, Velo, Amarilla, Montana, Carretera)
DAX Tables Created	Date Table (457 rows, 14 cols), Financial_Category (2,800 rows, 3 cols)
Dummy Tables Created	Country Measures, P&L Category, P&L Measures, Time_Intelligence
Total DAX Measures	10 P&L measures + 5 country measures + 4 time intelligence measures = 19 total
Visualisation Types	Waterfall, Bar, Donut/Pie, Line Trend, Data Tables, KPI Cards
Dashboard Pages	5 pages: Country, Income Statement, Quarterly/Trend, Product, Cost/Margin
Portfolio Platform	LinkedIn Data Analytics Portfolio

This document is part of a professional Data Analytics Portfolio published by Dr. Abraham Eninla (Data Analyst).

© 2024 — Financial Analysis Power BI Portfolio Project | All data sourced from Microsoft Power BI Desktop sample dataset